

OREGON STATE HOSPITAL

POLICY

SECTION 6: Patient Care **POLICY: 6.052**

SUBJECT: Trauma Screening

POINT PERSON: Chief Medical Officer

APPROVED: Sara Walker, MD  **DATE: JULY 25, 2024**
Interim Superintendent

SELECT ONE: ☐ New policy ☐ Minor/technical revision of existing policy
☒ Reaffirmation of existing policy ☐ Major revision of existing policy

I. PURPOSE AND APPLICABILITY

A. Oregon State Hospital (OSH) recognizes a patient may have trauma risk factors related to abuse, neglect, exploitation, or other adverse experiences. Therefore, OSH will screen each patient for trauma according to the principles of “universal design” and person-centered care. A trauma screening tool such as Attachment A of this policy will be used.

B. This policy applies to all staff who work directly with patients.

II. POLICY

A. Assessments completed during the admission process and ongoing assessments will include a review of past trauma experiences such as abuse, exploitation, and neglect.

1. Staff must demonstrate sensitivity when assessing a patient for trauma.

2. Staff must offer the patient trauma-specific and trauma-sensitive services or resources as needed.

B. A member of the interdisciplinary treatment team (IDT) will review a patient’s trauma history documented in assessments before IDT meetings to address in the patient’s treatment care plan as necessary.

C. Staff who work directly with patients will be knowledgeable about the long-term effects of psychological trauma in order to provide trauma-informed services that promote hope, safety, and recovery.

- D. OSH will offer trainings or professional development opportunities on trauma-informed approach and trauma-sensitive services to address initial, secondary, or vicarious trauma, abuse, exploitation or neglect, identification of internal or external triggers, risk factors, and treatment considerations.
- E. OSH follows all applicable regulations, including federal and state statutes and rules; Oregon Department of Administrative Services (DAS), Shared Services, and Oregon Health Authority (OHA) policies; and relevant accreditation standards. Such regulations supersede the provisions of this policy unless this policy is more restrictive.
- F. Staff who fail to comply with this policy or related policy attachments or protocols may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal.

III. DEFINITIONS

- A. "Person-centered care" recognizes that OSH places the person served at the center of treatment. HCP will collaborate with persons served to help them identify their hopes and dreams, understand their strengths and abilities, and recognize their needs and challenges.
- B. "Psychological trauma" refers to the cluster of symptoms, adaptations, and reactions that interfere with the functioning of an individual who has experienced extreme suffering as a result of: severe physical abuse or injury; neglect and deprivation; sexual abuse or exploitation; witnessing or surviving severe violence; or emotional abuse.
- C. "Staff" includes employees, volunteers, trainees, interns, contractors, vendors, and other state employees assigned to work at Oregon State Hospital (OSH).
- D. "Trauma-informed approach" is the demonstrated understanding of the profound neurological, biological, psychological, and social effects of trauma and violence on the individual and an appreciation for the high prevalence of traumatic experiences in persons who receive mental health and addiction services.
- E. "Trauma-sensitive services" are not specifically designed to treat symptoms or syndromes related to sexual, physical, or emotional abuse, other trauma, or neglect or exploitation, but they are services that are informed about, and sensitive to, trauma-related issues present in survivors. "Trauma-informed organizations, programs, and services are based on an understanding of the vulnerabilities or triggers of trauma survivors that traditional service delivery approaches may exacerbate, so that these services and programs can be more supportive and avoid re-traumatization" (SAMHSA). Trauma-sensitive services demonstrate a Universal Design approach to service delivery.
- F. "Trauma-specific services" are designed to treat the actual consequences of trauma, recognize adaptive 'symptoms', and the importance of collaborative,

person-directed treatment. These are the specific treatment and care interventions provided to a particular individual based on his or her identified needs.

- G. “Universal design” presumes that every person in a treatment setting has been exposed to abuse, violence, neglect, exploitation or other traumatic experiences. This perspective then informs all day-to-day interactions, creating a safe environment where people can more easily engage the healing and recovery process provided through treatment and care.

NOTE: These definitions should be interpreted so that they are consistent with the rules of the Oregon Health Authority, as well as national best practices and literature regarding these terms.

IV. ATTACHMENTS

Attachment A Primary Care (PC) PTSD Screen

V. RELATED OSH POLICIES AND PROTOCOLS

6.011 Treatment Care Planning

7.008 Patient Abuse or Mistreatment Allegation Reporting

VI. REFERENCES

Addictions & Mental Health Division. *Trauma-informed and trauma-specific services*. Retrieved from: <http://www.oregon.gov/oha/amh/pages/trauma.aspx>

Jennings, A. (2008). *Models for developing trauma-informed behavioral health systems and trauma-specific services*. Retrieved from: <https://duckduckgo.com/l/?kh=-1&uddg=http%3A%2F%2Fwww.theannainstitute.org%2FMDDT.pdf>

Joint Commission Resources, Inc. (2024). *The joint commission comprehensive accreditation manual for hospitals*, PC 01.02.09. Oakbrook Terrace, IL: Author.

Oregon Department of Human Services Addictions and Mental Health Division. (2006, February). *Trauma policy*. Retrieved from: <http://www.oregon.gov/oha/amh/pages/trauma.aspx>

Substance Abuse and Mental Health Administration. (2014, May 5). *National center for trauma informed care and alternatives to seclusion and restraint*. Retrieved from: <http://www.samhsa.gov/nctic/>